and had access to secretly held information in highly confidential documents, describes him as ‘an itinerant lecturer of the Arya Samaj’. However, in the proceedings against Kishen and Ajit Singh, during a search conducted in November 1909, ‘a box belonging to Professor Parmanand was examined, and in it was found a copy of the celebrated manual of explosives with some manuscripts relating to seditious and revolutionary schemes’.[4] It did not end there. Such was the obsession of the authorities with socialist literature regarded as subversive that James Ker also explains how in that search ‘[t]here were also a few old letters written by Lajpatrai to Parmanand in 1907, when the latter was in London studying history at King’s College, in which Lajpatrai asked him to procure certain books on socialistic and revolutionary subjects’.[5] In that febrile atmosphere, ‘a good deal of doubtful literature was consigned to the flames at this time in the colleges of Lahore and other cities of the Punjab’.[6] It was hardly surprising therefore that when the incriminating documents were discovered in Bhai Parmanand’s possession he was suspended from DAV College, and when the case was finally decided against him, he was dismissed.

He retired for a time to his own village, but in October 1910 he sailed from Bombay for Europe, ‘giving out that he was going to study medicine’.[7] He travelled to Paris and then to British Guiana, where in March 1911 ‘he was trying to make the Hindus in the Colony start a school, partly in order to prevent the Hindu children from being converted to Christianity (one of the main objects of the Arya Samaj)’.[8] But by September 1911 he found himself in California, and upon meeting the noted Ghadarite Har Dayal, ‘became one of his associates’. That too was short-lived, because in 1913 he left for England, but then in September of that year he was in Paris again. In this way, ‘[h]aving completed his tour of the revolutionary centres he arrived back in India in December, 1913, and returned to Lahore, and when the Ghadar movement started in the Punjab it was found that his house was a place of call for dangerous members of the party’. When one of the accused in the first Lahore Conspiracy Case of 1915 was traced back to Bhai Parmanand, his fate was sealed. The tribunal reached the unanimous conclusion that ‘this accused was not only one of